



Q

Why do we dry fruits and vegetables when preserving them at home?

DEHYDRATING AND SMOKING



Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

Drying removes moisture so microorganisms cannot grow.

FUN FACT

Drying is the oldest way people have preserved food!

Source: PNW 397 Drying fruits and vegetables



Q

At what temperature should you usually set your dehydrator to dry fruits and vegetables safely?



Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

Around 140°F to make sure the food dries properly.

FUN FACT

Keeping a steady temperature helps dry foods evenly and safely!

Source: SP 50-921 Drying herbs



Q

What happens if your dried herbs or vegetables still have moisture left when you store them?



Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

They may grow mold and spoil.

FUN FACT

Even a little moisture can let mold grow on your dried foods.

Source: SP 50-921 Drying herbs



Q

Why do we salty cure fish before smoking?

DEHYDRATING AND SMOKING



Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

Salt helps keep harmful bacteria from growing during smoking.

FUN FACT

Salt is like a superhero that helps keep smoked fish safe to eat!

Source: PNW 238 Smoking fish at home



Q

What is a pellicle when smoking fish?

DEHYDRATING AND SMOKING



Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

A shiny, sticky skin that forms on fish before smoking to help smoke stick.

FUN FACT

Pellicles help smoked fish get tasty smoky flavor evenly.

Source: PNW 238 Smoking fish at home



Q

Why must jerky be heated in an oven after drying?



Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

To kill any harmful germs that might still be in the meat.

FUN FACT

Oven-heating jerky after drying makes it safe to eat without cooking it fully earlier.

Source: PNW 632 Making jerky at home safely



Q

If you ground the meat before making jerky, what extra safety step should you do?

DEHYDRATING AND SMOKING



Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

Cook or heat it to destroy germs because grinding spreads bacteria.

FUN FACT

Grinding meat spreads germs, so heating is extra important for jerky safety.

Source: PNW 632 Making jerky at home safely



Q

What is the safe internal temperature you need to reach when smoking fish to prevent illness?

DEHYDRATING AND SMOKING



Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

At least 150°F, held for 30 minutes.

FUN FACT

Cooking fish to the right temperature keeps it safe and yummy!

Source: PNW 238 Smoking fish at home



Q

How long should fruit leather be dried in a dehydrator set at 140°F?



Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

About 10 hours until not sticky in the center.

FUN FACT

Fruit leather needs lots of gentle drying to get just right!

Source: SP 50-921 Drying herbs



Q

Why do we store dried fruit rolls tightly wrapped and in cool, dark places?



Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

To keep moisture out and prevent spoilage.

FUN FACT

Dried foods last longer when kept away from light and moisture.

Source: SP 50-921 Drying herbs



Q

What does smoking meat or fish do besides drying it?

DEHYDRATING AND SMOKING



Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

It adds flavor and helps preserve it.

FUN FACT

Smoke adds a yummy taste and helps slow food spoilage!

Source: PNW 238 Smoking fish at home



Q

Why do you place meat strips close but not touching when heating jerky in the oven?

DEHYDRATING AND SMOKING



Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

So heat reaches all sides evenly to kill germs properly.

FUN FACT

Good spacing helps your jerky cook safe and tasty all over.

Source: PNW 632 Making jerky at home safely



Q

When an adult is getting fish ready to smoke by soaking it in salty water, how much salt do they usually add to 7 cups of water to help keep the fish safe and tasty?

DEHYDRATING AND SMOKING



Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

1 cup of salt

FUN FACT

Using the right amount of salt in the salty water helps keep the fish safe and makes it taste good after smoking!

Source: PNW 238 Smoking fish at home



Q

What will happen if you dry jerky meat at low temperatures only without heating afterward?



Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

Some harmful bacteria might survive and make you sick.

FUN FACT

Low drying temperatures don't always kill bacteria-extra heat is important.

Source: PNW 632 Making jerky at home safely



Q

How should pieces of fish be arranged in the brine for salting before smoking?



Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

Pieces should not overlap for even salt uptake.

FUN FACT

Even salting helps fish taste right and stay safe.

Source: PNW 238 Smoking fish at home



Q

What is the main reason drying foods makes them shelf stable?



Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

Removing moisture stops bacteria and mold from growing.

FUN FACT

Without water, tiny germs can't spoil your dried snacks!

Source: PNW 397 Drying fruits and vegetables



Q

Why do you want to keep smoked fish refrigerated after smoking?



Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

To stop any harmful bacteria from growing after smoking.

FUN FACT

Even smoked fish can grow germs if left warm too long!

Source: PNW 238 Smoking fish at home



Q

What does conditioning jerky mean after drying and heating it?



Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

Storing it loosely in a container to balance moisture and prevent mold.

FUN FACT

Conditioning helps keep your jerky safe and chewy-not too dry or damp.

Source: PNW 632 Making jerky at home safely



Q

What is one important reason to prepare fish pieces of uniform thickness before salting and smoking?



Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

So salt and heat get inside evenly, making fish safe to eat.

FUN FACT

Same-size fish pieces cook and salt evenly for safety and flavor.

Source: PNW 238 Smoking fish at home



Q

What should you do if your dried fruit leather cools before peeling off the tray?



Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

Warm it slightly in the dehydrator to make peeling easier.

FUN FACT

Warming fruit leather slightly helps it peel without tearing.

Source: SP 50-921 Drying herbs